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Naturally Leavened Bomboloni (Doughnuts)

Light. Airy. Tender. Certainly the best doughnuts to come out of my kitchen.

By Maurizio Leo(https://www.theperfectloaf.com/author/maurizio/)

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310 Comments (https://www.theperfectloaf.com/naturally-leavened-bomboloni-doughnuts/#comments)

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Our sleep was always broken by a small, three-wheeled cart scurrying down the stone streets with a large megaphone strapped to the roof. Political ramblings poured unrestricted out of that speaker, echoing off buildings and stone-paved streets

as it ran down the length of each avenue—faster and louder than I'm sure anyone in our family's hometown in Southern Italy cared for. Without the desire for air conditioning, every house had its window open overnight to let in the cool breeze. And the opportunistic man in the speedy cart was keenly aware of this situation. As a kid traveling to visit family, waking early wasn't nearly as bad as going to bed early; after all, it just meant you'd get to play sooner.

But probably my favorite thing of all, and the reason I secretly hoped that man would drive by even earlier, was it meant heading out early with my dad and brother to the local baker for fresh naturally leavened bomboloni (doughnuts).

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Back then, I didn't quite appreciate the lives these bakers led. For them to sell fresh baked goods first thing in the morning, they likely worked through the night: mixing, folding, shaping dough, and finally baking in the old ovens just as the sun streamed

through the city streets. We'd walk in oblivious to all of this, instead focused acutely on which pastry to buy and devour on the walk back. I like to think our enthusiasm for their baked goods somehow validated their long night of hard work. I do know they were there every morning, ready to discuss a recent soccer game, wrap the pastry in a paper, and send us back on our way.

Naturally leavened bomboloni are essentially sourdough doughnuts (with no sourness). They're also known as berliner, krapfen, ballen, pączki, donut, and many more names all over the world. It seems everyone at some point figured out that frying enriched dough was incredibly delicious. I'm sure glad they did.

s://www.theperfectloaf.com/wp-content/uploads/2018/03/theperfectloaf-naturally-ned-bomboloni-doughnuts-14.jpg)

These bomboloni fry up so light and airy you can see why almost every culture has had their own incarnation. When I filled the first one with pastry cream (read on for the recipe) and took that first bite I was instantly transported back to my childhood in Italy. I almost always opted for the cream-filled variety but in the off chance they didn't have one, the jelly ones came in at second choice. Let's get frying.

*Be sure to read to the end for a **new troubleshooting section**, a recipe for crema pasticerra, and a recipe for the sugar/cinnamon coating.*

Naturally Leavened Bomboloni (Doughnuts)

Recipe

These can be challenging to execute properly and do take some practice. Use the photos in this post and the following four extremely important details to ensure success. To make these as light as air, you will need:

1. A **strong levain (https://www.theperfectloaf.com/what-is-a-levain-and-how-is-it-different-from-a-starter/)**
2. Sufficient **dough strength** (lots of mixing, almost to full "windowpane")
3. Lengthy, **warm** bulk fermentation and final proof (see my post on the **Importance of Dough Temperature (https://www.theperfectloaf.com/the-importance-of-dough-temperature-in-baking/)** for more)
4. **Delicate handling** when transferring from proof tray to frying oil

I'll delve more into each of the above during their step in the process below, but I want to highlight these important elements at the start. First and foremost, strong fermentation is absolutely critical. This begins with your sourdough starter and, subsequently, your levain. Make sure your starter is fed regularly, and you use a ripe starter to create your levain.

(https://www.theperfectloaf.com/wp-content/uploads/2018/03/theperfectloaf-naturally-leavened-bomboloni-doughnuts-7.jpg)

Due to the sugar and other enrichments in this dough, overall fermentation activity will be reduced. To counter this, the bulk fermentation and proof steps will need to be lengthened. In addition, it's also very important to keep the dough warm during each of these steps!

Vitals

If you'd like to double this recipe to make more doughnuts just multiply everything in the Build and Formula section by two. I would *not* recommend halving the recipe, a total dough weight of 1200g is already quite small for a stand mixer and to ensure sufficient dough mass for fermentation.

Total Dough Weight	1200 grams
Yield	18 x 65 gram bomboloni

Levain Build

A 100% hydration levain made with all white flour will be very mild and not overly acidic. Be sure to use this levain when it's strong and ripe but not overly so: it should be used right about when it reaches its peak height and looks very active.

Weight	Ingredient	Baker's Percentage
45g	Mature 100% hydration starter	50%
90g	All-Purpose White Flour (King Arthur Unbleached All Purpose)	100%
90g	Water	100%

Dough Formula

Target final dough temperature (FDT) is **76-78°F (24-25°C)**. If your FDT is slightly lower than this, that's fine, just be sure to keep the dough around 78°F (25°C) during bulk, and it should get back up to temperature rather quickly.

Weight	Ingredient	Baker's Percentage
253g	All-Purpose White Flour (King Arthur Unbleached All Purpose)	50.00%
253g	High Protein Bread Flour (**King Arthur Bread Flour (https://www.theperfectloaf.com/kabbf)**)	50.00%
187g	Eggs (about 3 large + 1 yolk, cold from the fridge)	37.00%
101g	Unsalted Butter (European Style, Kerrygold)	20.00%
101g	Fine White Sugar	20.00%
91g	Water	18.00%
10g	Salt	2.00%
203g	Mature 100% hydration levain	40.00%

(https://www.theperfectloaf.com/wp-content/uploads/2018/03/theperfectloaf-naturally-leavened-bomboloni-doughnuts-6.jpg)

Method

1. Levain – 9:30 a.m.

Using a **ripe sourdough starter (https://www.theperfectloaf.com/7-easy-steps-making-incredible-sourdough-starter-scratch/)**, build the levain (everything listed in

the Levain Build section, above) in the morning and store somewhere around 78°F (25°C) ambient until ripe, about 5 hours.

2. Mix – 2:00 p.m.

First, measure out the required **butter** and cut into 1/2" chunks. Leave this out at room temperature to soften while mixing the other ingredients.

Measure out the called for **eggs**: crack three full eggs into a small bowl on a scale. If the weight is close to the requirement, add only the yolk of the remaining fourth egg to get to the required amount, if not add the entire egg. Lightly whisk to break the yolks and incorporate.

The **paddle attachment** is far more efficient at strengthening this type **enriched dough (https://www.theperfectloaf.com/what-does-butter-do-to-bread-dough/)**. As it's mixing you'll notice the dough will tend to cling to the middle of the paddle and press to the sides of the bowl. Stop periodically during mixing to scrape the paddle and sides to reincorporate. At the end of the second phase of mixing the dough should almost pass the "windowpane" test (full development). We will do a few sets of stretch and folds during bulk to finish strengthening the dough.

To the bowl of a stand mixer fitted with the paddle attachment, add the **flour**, **sugar**, **eggs**, **levain**, **salt**, and **water**. If the dough is overly dry add in a little bit more water (be cautious doing so, we don't want to have a dough that's too wet).

Set the mixer to STIR and mix for about a minute until everything comes together. Set mixer to SPEED TWO and mix for 5 minutes. At the end of this time, the dough will still stick to the bottom and sides of the bowl but it will start to clump up around the paddle.

Let the dough rest for 10 minutes.

Check your butter. It should be pliable and show a finger indent when lightly pressed. If it's still cold, place in the microwave for 10 seconds or so. It shouldn't be melted, just pliable.

Set your mixer to SPEED THREE and mix for 9-10 minutes. During this time add the butter to the bowl, one small chunk at a time. Wait until each chunk is absorbed into the dough before adding the next.

The slow-motion video to the right shows my dough midway through the second phase of mixing after the butter has been incorporated. You can see the dough has balled up around the paddle but overall it still needs further development. At this point stop the mixer, scrape down the sides and paddle and continue mixing. You will have to do this several times throughout mixing.

Near the end of this mixing, the dough will almost pass the windowpane test. Using wet hands grab a chunk of dough and gently spread it out with your fingers. If mixed sufficiently, you'll see a thin membrane that will barely start to rip when stretched out.

When finished, transfer the dough to a container for warm bulk fermentation.

3. Warm Bulk Fermentation – 2:30 p.m. to 8:30 p.m.

This dough requires a long and warm bulk fermentation. At 78°F (25°C), the dough will ferment 6 hours before it's placed in the fridge overnight. I place my entire bulk container in my **dough proofer (https://www.theperfectloaf.com/proofer)** set to this temperature (see my **guide to using a dough proofer (https://www.theperfectloaf.com/how-to-use-the-brod-and-taylor-dough-proofer/)** if you're unfamiliar with their use)

Perform a total of 4 sets of **stretch and folds during bulk (https://www.theperfectloaf.com/guides/how-to-stretch-and-fold-sourdough/)**, spaced out by 30 minutes (starting 30 minutes after mixing finishes).

After the last set (2 hours into bulk), let the dough rest for the remaining 4 hours. By the end of the 6 hours, the dough should have risen by at least 30%. Ensure the bulk container is covered and place it in the refrigerator overnight for cold bulk fermentation.

4. Cold Bulk Fermentation – 8:30 p.m. to 8:00 a.m. (next day)

(https://www.theperfectloaf.com/wp-content/uploads/2018/03/theperfectloaf-naturally-leavened-bomboloni-doughnuts-2.jpg)

The duration of this cold bulk fermentation step is very flexible. The dough can continue to rest in the fridge several more hours (or perhaps even more) after I have listed here if desired. Take it out and proceed with the rest of the process when convenient.

Above, you can see the activity in my dough after the warm and cold bulk steps—it's active and alive, even though at this point it's cold and firm from the fridge.

5. Divide & Shape – 8:00 a.m.

Take the cold bulk fermentation container out of the fridge, uncover, and dump the dough to an un-floured work surface. The dough will feel very cold and stiff, which is exactly what we want. You might need a little flour on your hands to prevent sticking but keep this to a minimum: we're looking for maximum friction between the dough and the work surface to create very tight rounds.

(https://www.theperfectloaf.com/wp-content/uploads/2018/03/theperfectloaf-naturally-leavened-bomboloni-doughnuts-13.jpg)

(https://www.theperfectloaf.com/wp-content/uploads/2018/03/theperfectloaf-naturally-leavened-bomboloni-doughnuts-15.jpg)

Using your scale, divide the mass of dough into eighteen 65g pieces. You might have a little leftover dough, perfect for engaging a little helper in the kitchen, as you can see below.

Using your hands preshape the dough pieces into rounds. Each round needs to have a very taut surface and no seam on the bottom. Use the side of your hand to push the round against the surface to tighten the surface.

Shaping these naturally leavened bomboloni is very similar to **how I shape buns and rolls (https://www.theperfectloaf.com/guides/shaping-buns-and-rolls/)**.

6. Proof – 8:15 a.m. to 7:30 p.m. (appx. 12 hours)

To proof these rounds I use two rectangular **pizza trays (https://www.theperfectloaf.com/sourdough-pizza-dough-and-recipes/)** (a covered baking sheet will also work well) dusted liberally with flour. I can fit 8 rounds in each tray with room for them to expand during the proof. The remaining two rounds I place in two floured Pyrex storage containers (these are good to test with when you start frying).

Place the covered trays with the rounds in a warm spot, around 78°F (25°C), for 12 hours. Since the trays are too large for my dough proofer, I keep them in my oven with the light on and periodically check to ensure they're kept warm.

(https://www.theperfectloaf.com/wp-content/uploads/2018/03/theperfectloaf-naturally-leavened-bomboloni-doughnuts-tall-1.jpg)

Let the dough proof for about 12 hours. It's very important the dough is fully proofed before you begin to fry these. They should almost double in size and be very puffy and delicate. If you gently poke them they will feel like they are completely filled with air. Below, you can see the difference between the just-shaped rounds in the image in the previous step.

If you'd rather fry these in the morning you could stop the proof a few hours before completion and finish proofing them in the morning. If you refrigerate them when they are fully proofed, the bomboloni might not fry with quite the same height the next day as they would if frying at night (the longer the proof, the less rise you'll see).

I've done both ways, including splitting the batch into two sessions, making one batch the night they're mixed and one the next day, and they both turn out beautifully.

You can also refrigerate the proofed dough at this point and fry them first thing in the morning for breakfast.

7. Fry – 7:30 p.m. (or put in the fridge until next day)

Frying Tools

- Vegetable oil, **refined coconut oil (my preference) (https://amzn.to/2GwDqNK)**, or any frying oil
- **Lodge 3.2 qt combo cooker (https://amzn.to/2Ggu9IE)** (the same one I use to bake bread!) to hold the frying oil
- **Thermoworks ChefAlarm frying thermometer (https://www.thermoworks.com/ChefAlarm?tw=TPL)** (or a standard **Frying thermometer (https://amzn.to/2Gdq7Ro)**)
- Timer (I love my **Thermoworks Big & Loud timer (https://www.thermoworks.com/Extra-Big-Loud?tw=TPL)**)
- **Frying spoon (https://amzn.to/2u8H1M5)**
- Baking sheet lined with paper towels and a cooling rack inside

Frying Oil, Type & Temperature

I've experimented with both canola and vegetable oil for frying these naturally leavened bomboloni (doughnuts), and much prefer vegetable between the two (but I will be using coconut oil from here on out, see *Update* below). Canola imparted a slightly odd flavor to my initial test batch and it has an off-putting smell to me. You will have to experiment with the frying temperature. At an oil temperature of 360-370°F (182-187°C) mine cook to a nice golden brown in 2.5 minutes per side.

Update:
I recently tried frying with *refined coconut oil* (I **purchased this tub of refined coconut oil (https://amzn.to/2GwDqNK)**, which should last quite a while (be sure to get refined oil as the smoke point is high enough for frying) and the results were very, very good. Because this oil is solid at room temperature, once the bomboloni cool, they

become even crispier and have a little oily feeling to them. Additionally, when frying, the oil doesn't give off unwanted smells in the kitchen. The resulting bomboloni tasted very similar to vegetable oil and did not have any coconut flavor to them.

You can see a shot of my **coconut-oil-fried-bomboloni on Instagram (https://www.instagram.com/p/BhCpbRoAOLX/?taken-by=maurizio)**.

Fry

Before beginning, place the trays with fully proofed dough in the refrigerator while you get the frying station setup. It's much easier to transfer the delicate rounds from tray to oil when they're a little more firm.

Meanwhile, fill the deep side of the combo cooker to about 2/3 full with frying oil and set over medium heat. The heavy cast iron combo cooker will help keep the oil at a more consistent temperature, even after adding the cool rounds of dough. Place the **frying thermometer (https://amzn.to/2Gdq7Ro)** on the side of the pot and heat until the oil registers 360-370°F (182-187°C).

(https://www.theperfectloaf.com/wp-content/uploads/2018/03/theperfectloaf-naturally-leavened-bomboloni-doughnuts-4.jpg)

Set your **timer (https://www.thermoworks.com/Extra-Big-Loud?tw=TPL)** for 2.5 minutes. Gently transfer one round from the proofing tray to oil using the **frying spoon (https://amzn.to/2u8H1M5)** so the *smooth top of the dough is down in the oil* first. Flipping the dough over helps to get a nice uniform roundness on the bottom and encourages initial upward expansion.

Keep a close eye on the frying thermometer, the oil temperature will drop each time you add new dough to fry. Constantly monitor and adjust the heat on your range to keep the oil at just the right temperature. I can comfortably fry 3 rounds of dough at a time in the Lodge Combo Cooker. If you have a larger Dutch oven you could accommodate more.

s://www.theperfectloaf.com/wp-content/uploads/2018/03/theperfectloaf-naturally-ned-bomboloni-doughnuts-5.jpg)

I prefer the look and texture after frying these for 2.5 minutes per side, but if you'd like them lighter reduce the fry time. When fully cooked, use your frying spoon to transfer each bomboloni to the baking sheet lined with a paper towel and cooling rack inside. Let cool several few minutes then toss in a mixture of sugar & cinnamon. Later, pipe with crema pasticcera (recipe below), if desired.

Cinnamon & Sugar Coating

This couldn't be more simple. Mix the following in a bowl and when the bomboloni are still slightly warm, toss to coat several times. I prefer large, granulated sugar for the

coating but you could also use fine sugar.

Weight	Ingredient
2g (1 teaspoon)	Cinnamon, ground
200g (1 cup)	Sugar, coarse or fine granulation

Crema Pasticcera (Pastry Cream) Recipe

I adore adding lemon zest to this pastry cream. It's subtle but noticeable, and somehow reminds me of the summer days spent back in Italy. Additionally, this recipe is a great base for many other types of creams (coffee, chocolate, fruit-flavored, etc.).

This recipe makes enough crema to fill half the bomboloni, depending on how much you pipe in and it can easily be doubled.

Ingredients

Weight	Ingredient
365g	Whole milk
30g	All-purpose white flour (King Arthur Unbleached All Purpose)
100g	Fine white sugar

Weight	Ingredient
4	Large egg yolks
1g	Salt
4g	Vanilla extract
1 lemon	Lemon zest (optional but encouraged)

Method

Gather a whisk, strainer, saucepan, and two medium mixing bowls.

1. Place the **milk** in a saucepan over medium heat. Warm until bubbles start to form on the sides (just before boiling but do **not** boil)
2. In a medium mixing bowl mix together **flour**, **salt**, and **sugar**. Add the **egg yolks**

and whisk everything until incorporated. It'll form a thick paste — just make sure everything is mixed together

3. Pour the **warm milk** into the egg mixture a little bit at a time, whisking to incorporate after each addition
4. Pour everything in the mixing bowl back into the saucepan over medium heat. Whisk constantly as the mixture heats. Continue heating and whisking until the contents just begin to boil (you'll see large bubbles popping when you pause to whisk)
5. Strain the mixture into another bowl. You'll have to press and stir the thickened cream through the strainer
6. Add the **vanilla extract** and **lemon zest** and stir to incorporate
7. Cover the bowl with plastic wrap pressed to the surface of the cream (to prevent a skin from forming in the fridge) and refrigerate until firm

The crema will keep well for 3-4 days in the fridge. Use a **piping bag (https://amzn.to/2pyyGMh)** and paring knife to fill the bomboloni just before serving. Make a small cut on the side with the knife, insert the piping bag, and squeeze in the desired amount.

Conclusion

s://www.theperfectloaf.com/wp-content/uploads/2018/03/theperfectloaf-naturally-ned-bomboloni-doughnuts-10.jpg)

These are such a treat; I love making them for special events (birthdays!), holiday weekends, or group gatherings. With my recipes for **sourdough waffles and pancakes (https://www.theperfectloaf.com/my-top-3-leftover-sourdough-starter-recipes/)**, I have lots of options for weekend breakfasts. It's easy enough to prepare the dough a day or two in advance, proof overnight, and have fresh bomboloni first thing in the morning. Because the dough is rather flexible, once you dial in the bulk and proof times, and develop a sense for when they are ready, you can adjust the schedule to make these in advance until ready to fry. And because frying is such a straightforward process, they're a quick and easy thing to whip up once the dough is ready.

Crust, Crumb, and Texture

Impossibly light is the perfect adjective to describe these naturally leavened bomboloni. They are soft, pliant, and have just the slightest hint of crisp at the top and bottom. I like to fry them just a touch toward the darker side to emphasize the contrast between crispy crust and tender interior — it works well to further emphasize the overall lightness of each doughnut.

The coarse sugar coating adds a little extra crunch with each bite, even if the sugar tends to scatter readily, and the ones filled with crema pasticerra are in a league of their own. Each person seems to have a preference for just how much crema they want inside, but there's really no wrong answer. Go big, no one is going to complain!

Taste

Maurizio Leo

(https://www.theperfectloaf.com/author/maurizio/)

Maurizio Leo is the creator of the independent sourdough baking website The Perfect Loaf. His cookbook, The Perfect Loa — The Craft and Science o Sourdough Breads, Sweet and More, is a James Bear Award-winner and a New York Times bestseller. He lives in Albuquerque, NM, with his wife and two sons where he's been baking sourdough for over a decade. He's been labeled "Bob Ross but for bread."

(https://www.theperfectloaf.com/author/maurizio/)

s://www.theperfectloaf.com/wp-content/uploads/2018/03/theperfectloaf-naturally-ned-bomboloni-doughnuts-9.jpg)

With no sourness at all, these bomboloni are, to me, the perfect breakfast indulgence. My target was for a result that wasn't overly sweet or rich but rather one that was just on the edge of each of these. The end result is one that certainly tastes fantastic on its own with a light dusting of sugar, but transforms to something truly magical when filled with crema.

Do sourdough posts like this help you in your baking? Join **The Baker's Corner (https://**

www.theperfectloaf.com/membership/?utm_source=tpl-internal&utm_content=post-footer) for only $60 a year, and get:

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- Get my bakers tools & discounts
- Get the full recipe archive in editable spreadsheets

Yes, I'll Join!

If you use this recipe, tag @maurizio.on.instagram (https://www.instagram.com/maurizio.on/) so I can take a look!

Those bombolini embody my childhood trips to Italy and our visits to the local town baker. Each morning as I take a bite into one fresh from frying, I'm whisked away back to traveling Southern Italy to visit family. The only thing missing, for better or worse, is the morning visit from the three-wheeled cart with megaphone rigged to the top. Although, now at home, I simply use my alarm clock — at least it has a snooze button.

Buon appetito!

Troubleshooting & How I Got Here

Step one is significant amount of time testing and developing this method and process. This recipe started with my **brioche-like hamburger buns (https://**

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Name

ough

d. I

tested various amounts for sugar, butter, and eggs and settled on the formula above. The result is a doughnut that fries up t and airy with requisite richness and sweetness. And they're so, so perfect for filling with cream.

23 Share Best Newest Oldest

Below are a few common problems you might run into when attempting this recipe (and the same things I struggled with in the beginning). *Click on the symptom* to reveal possible causes with suggested fixes.

LS liam s
19 days ago
can you make these with regular instant or bakers yeast?
0 0 Reply

M michele
24 days ago
hi there so confused with the different recipes this one on ;ine and the one in the book. Read the comments below and still confused. This recipe was updated in April 2025 but yet you say the book is the most recent updated recipe? I've had my book for 3 - 4 years now so which recipe is the right recipe?
0 0 Reply

Maurizio Leo michele
22 days ago
Hey Michele! Both are really great recipes. The book version I find has less sourness in the final

Hey Michele! Both are really great recipes. The book version I find has less sourness in the final doughnut, which I prefer. I'm in the process of updating this post to be just like the book. Sorry for the confusion, let me know how they turn out, you're going to love em 🙂 Also hope you're enjoying my book!

0 0 Reply

Tanya
8 months ago

Is the dough necessary until the dough achieves this? Typically, this takes between 5 and 6 hours at 78-80°F (25-26°C).

0 0 Reply

Lenna
10 months ago

Also, you let the shaped dough fully rise on their second proof before putting in the fridge? I'd be concerned they'd overproof.

0 0 Reply

Nick Verdi
10 months ago

This recipe is horridly different than what is in his cookbook. I am incredibly disappointed and think I could see that, unless I could find a cookbook with less covers the dough, but I do very much appreciate

0 0 Reply

Maurizio Leo → Nick Verdi
10 months ago

Sorry about that, Nick. Yes the book is the most updated version. I am overdue on updating this one to match the book. Thank you for the reminder!

0 0 Reply

Al → Maurizio Leo
8 months ago

Yes, and please update the misprint in the book. 32g of water cannot be right. The dough is so stiff!

0 0 Reply

Nick Verdi → Maurizio Leo
10 months ago

Thank you for the reply. The book says 32 grams of water, which was simply not enough as the dough was incredibly tough. I added 59 additional grams to equal the 91 grams in this recipe. Can you confirm if you have noticed these issues?

Why is there no rise while the dough is proofing?

The time and temperature required to bulk ferment and final proof this dough is very critical. If the dough is not warm enough and left to bulk ferment long enough there will not be sufficient activity in the dough before it's placed in the fridge overnight (retarded). Ensure the dough rises at least 30% during bulk fermentation, push out bulk as long as necessary until the dough achieves this. Typically, this takes between 5 and 6 hours at 78-80°F (25-26°C).

When frying, why do I get large bubbles on the top or sides?

I've noticed there are a few things that could lead to massive bubbles forming when frying a bomboloni. The first is a dough that is not strong enough and required more mixing. The dough should almost pass the windowpane test when done mixing, and the four sets of stretch and folds during bulk will finish imparting the required strength. From there, the dough needs to be lightly degassed during shaping and shaped tight. There should be no seams on each shaped round. Finally, the under-proofed dough can cause erratic, uncontrolled bubbles to form. The rounds need to be fully proofed and, when poked, feel like very gassy and light pillows. They will seem almost over proofed.

Why does butter leak out of the dough?

The butter should be incorporated into the already-strengthened dough when it's at room temperature, not melted. When pressed with a finger, you'll see an indentation but it shouldn't be a puddle of liquid butter. If the butter has melted, place it back into the fridge and let it firm up before adding to the dough.

Why does the butter never mix into the dough?

If the butter is too cold and not pliable, it won't incorporate easily into the dough when mixing. See the question above for how the butter should look and feel.

0 0 Reply

R **Reuben Radcliffe**
a year ago

Silly question, but would you be able to air fry these rather than deep fat fry them?

0 0 Reply

Maurizio Leo → Reuben Radcliffe
10 months ago

I haven't tried but I would say yes. You might not get quite the same texture, but worth a shot. I know some bakers who have baked these instead of fry!

0 0 Reply

P **Precious Lewis**
a year ago

What happens when you don't let it
BF up to 30% during the first rise and you place it in the fridge? Does your starter die will your dough not rise? I bulk fermented for about 7 hrs, didn't have much rise and then placed it in the fridge. I sat the dough out the next day for an hour to get to room temperature and then I divided they're on day two of no rise. I haven't had any issues with my starter before, I also used the recipe from the book.

0 0 Reply

Maurizio Leo → Precious Lewis
10 months ago

That works just fine, as long as you get enough fermentation in the dough before you put it in the fridge. Though, even if you don't, it'll still pick back up the next day, it'll just take a lot longer.

Check out how I do this with my sourdough baguettes . I do a 2 hour warm room temp bulk, then pop it into the fridge. (It's in the book , too).

0 0 Reply

PG **Paul G**
a year ago

I just made these for the first time and they were great.

Only issue I had was removing the Bombolini from the cookie sheet after the proof. I think they stuck to the floured parchment paper I used, and I will try a floured cookie sheet next time.

I successfully made a half recipe, but it require a bit of flexibility with the stand mixer. I started out thinking I could mud by hand, but this is far too sticky of a dough for that.

Don’t worry if the dough is sticky after mixing. It relaxes a lot during the folding.

0 0 Reply

Maurizio Leo → Paul G

a year ago

Great tips Paul. Yea, you need a good dusting of flour on that pan!

0 0 Reply

S

Sandra

2 years ago

Are these best made with a liquid starter or a stiff starter? I have both here: a regular liquid starter and a pasta madre and am wondering which would yield the better results.

0 0 Reply

Maurizio Leo → Sandra

a year ago

Technically, a stiff starter would be better, but I use a liquid!

0 0 Reply

Joshua Kravitz

2 years ago edited

When I make these I consistently get a very blistery top and a very dull untextured bottom. Why the difference? How do you manage to get the consistent appearance on both bottom and top? (This is me being picky -- these were delicious!)

0 0 Reply

Maurizio Leo → Joshua Kravitz

a year ago

Glad they turned out great, Joshua! I sometimes get the blisters too. I'm not fully sure why, I think it has to do with the cold fermentation with this dough... Still investigating this! (And if anyone knows, I'd love to hear 🙂)

0 0 Reply

H

Helen

2 years ago

In directions you advise against cutting the recipe in half because this will not be a 'sufficient dough mass for bulk fermentation'. Could you please explain?

0 0 Reply

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I can’t keep my dough at 78°F (25°C) during bulk and proof,

what can I do?

As I mentioned in the post above, bulk and proof temperatures are very important with this recipe. If you're not able to keep the dough warm enough during these steps, it could take several hours longer at each step before it's ready to proceed to the next. Watch the dough and give it the time it needs!

Can I freeze this dough?

I have not tried to freeze this dough but others have reported successfully freezing my brioche hamburger buns. I would be wary to do this, though, and would first like to test before saying yes/no!

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